

PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

TradeIndia Mobile App

Trust & Stability Initiative

Document Version v1.0	Status Draft — For Review	Last Updated July 2024	Owner Product Manager
Product TradeIndia Android App	Target Release Q4 2024 (Phase 1)	Stakeholders Eng · Design · Support · Sales	Reviewers VP Product · Eng Lead · UX Lead

1. Executive Summary

This document defines the product requirements for the TradeIndia App Trust & Stability Initiative — a structured set of improvements across three release phases (Q4 2024 through Q2 2025) designed to address user trust erosion, app instability, and lead quality gaps identified through systematic analysis of 580 Google Play Store reviews (December 2017 – Q3 2025).

The analysis revealed a 2.28 average star rating in 2025 — a meaningful decline from 2.70 in 2023 — with 107 of 187 reviews in 2025 being 1-star. The root causes are clustered around three product areas: app reliability, UI/navigation usability, and lead quality for paid subscribers. Unaddressed, these issues drive paid subscriber churn and suppress new user acquisition through poor store presence.

This PRD focuses on the product requirements necessary to stabilize the app, improve core user flows, and rebuild trust with the SME seller segment. It does not cover TradeIndia's buyer-side experience or web platform.

2. Background & Problem Statement

2.1 Context

TradeIndia is one of India's largest B2B trade portals, serving SME suppliers across manufacturing, export, and service categories. The mobile app is the primary interface for sellers to manage product listings, access buyer leads, and communicate with potential customers. The platform competes directly with IndiaMART (4.1★ rated) and JustDial (3.8★ rated) for the same SME audience.

2.2 Problem Statement

The TradeIndia mobile app is experiencing a slow but measurable erosion of user trust, driven by recurring app instability, friction-heavy UI flows, and a growing perception that paid subscriptions do not deliver promised ROI. The current 2.28 average rating (2025) represents a competitive liability against category leaders rated 4.1 and above.

2.3 Evidence Base

Signal	Finding
Total reviews analyzed	580 reviews spanning December 2017 – Q3 2025
2025 rating trend	107 of 187 reviews in 2025 were 1-star (57%)
Average rating (2025)	2.28 / 5.0 — down from 2.70 in 2023
Top negative theme	App instability: 87 of 280 negative reviews (31%) mention 'app' crashes, login failures, or broken flows
UI friction	41 of 280 negative reviews (15%) cite navigation issues or broken account management
Lead quality	18 of 280 negative reviews (6%) cite irrelevant leads or zero business ROI after payment
Support perception	99.5% of reviews receive a reply — but replies are templated; users report no resolution
Competitor gap	IndiaMART rated 4.1★; JustDial 3.8★ — TradeIndia's 2.28★ is a clear acquisition deterrent

3. Goals & Non-Goals

3.1 Goals

- Eliminate the top app stability blockers (OTP login failures, image upload crashes, notification hard gates) that prevent users from completing core tasks
- Reduce UI friction on the five most-used seller workflows (product listing, account management, lead viewing, catalogue update, contact update)
- Improve perceived lead quality by introducing basic geographic and category filters at onboarding and lead delivery
- Shift support from templated acknowledgements to SLA-driven resolution, reducing repeat complaints on the same issues
- Move the Play Store average rating directionally from 2.28 toward 2.8–3.0 within six months of Phase 1 release

3.2 Non-Goals

The following are explicitly out of scope for this initiative and should not be picked up without a separate discovery and scoping exercise.

- Buyer-side app or web experience improvements
- Full redesign or rebrand of the app UI — this is an improvement initiative, not a redesign
- ML-based lead matching or recommendation engine (Phase 3+ backlog)
- TradeIndia.com web platform changes (separate roadmap)

- iOS app — Phase 1 and 2 scope Android only; iOS parity is a follow-on initiative
- Pricing, packaging, or sales process changes — acknowledged as a contributing factor but outside product's direct control

4. User Personas

Three primary personas were identified from review analysis. All three are Android users; desktop/web users are out of scope for this PRD.

	Ramesh — The Paid Subscriber	Priya — The New Lister	Anil — The Casual Browser
	SME manufacturer, 2+ years on platform, paid premium package (₹30,000–₹50,000/yr)	Small trader or artisan, recently onboarded, exploring free or starter listing	Occasional user who browses leads but does not actively manage listings
	Generate qualified buyer inquiries that convert to orders and justify subscription cost	Get products visible online, understand the platform, receive first inquiry	Check lead notifications periodically; contact interesting buyers quickly
	Leads from wrong geography or irrelevant category; app crashes when uploading images; feels deceived by sales pitch	OTP login loop prevents access; difficult to update profile or catalogue; notification gate blocks first action	App feels slow; hard to find contact info for leads; no clear next step after viewing a lead
	HIGH — will not renew subscription if lead quality and app reliability don't improve	MEDIUM — may abandon before completing setup if onboarding flow is broken	LOW — low investment; may simply stop opening the app

5. User Stories

5.1 App Stability

- **US-01** As a seller, I want to log in with OTP without getting stuck in an infinite retry loop, so that I can access my account reliably on every session.
- **US-02** As a seller, I want to upload product images without the app crashing, so that I can keep my catalogue up to date without losing my work.
- **US-03** As a new user, I want to proceed through app setup without being forced to enable notifications before I can do anything, so that I can evaluate the product on my own terms.
- **US-04** As a seller, I want to update my WhatsApp number and it to save correctly on the first attempt, so that buyers can reach me through my preferred channel.

5.2 UI & Navigation

- **US-05** As a seller, I want to update my contact number in fewer than three taps, so that I can keep my profile current without hunting through settings menus.
- **US-06** As a seller, I want to delete or deactivate a listed product directly from the listing page, so that I don't have to navigate to a separate management screen.

- **US-07** As a seller, I want my product catalogue to display all images correctly when browsing, so that I can verify how my listings appear to buyers.
- **US-08** As a seller, I want the app's main navigation to surface my most-used actions (leads, catalogue, profile) within one tap of the home screen, so that I can work efficiently on a small screen.

5.3 Lead Quality

- **US-09** As a paid subscriber, I want to set my delivery geography during onboarding, so that I only receive leads from buyers within my serviceable area.
- **US-10** As a paid subscriber, I want to indicate my product categories and minimum order size, so that I receive leads that match my actual business rather than generic inquiries.
- **US-11** As a paid subscriber, I want to mark a lead as 'not relevant' with one tap, so that the system can improve my lead feed over time.

5.4 Support & Communication

- **US-12** As a user with a complaint, I want to receive a personalised acknowledgement within 24 hours and a resolution update within 5 business days, so that I feel my issue is being actively worked on.
- **US-13** As a new subscriber, I want to see a clear 'what to expect in your first 30 days' guide during onboarding, so that I have realistic expectations about lead volume ramp-up time.

6. Functional Requirements

Requirements are tagged by Phase and Priority. MoSCoW notation: M = Must Have, S = Should Have, C = Could Have.

Phase 1 — Stabilize (Target: Q4 2024)

FR-1.1 OTP Login Flow Fix

Field	Detail
User Story	US-01
Priority	M — Must Have
Description	Fix the OTP verification session management so that a correctly entered OTP always authenticates the user on the first valid attempt.
Acceptance Criteria	1. A valid OTP entered within its expiry window authenticates the user with a success rate ≥ 99%. 2. If the OTP expires, the user sees a 'Resend OTP' button without needing to restart the login flow. 3. After 3 failed attempts, the user is shown a 'Contact Support' option with a pre-filled email template. 4. Session tokens are invalidated correctly on logout to prevent stale token conflicts on re-login.
Out of Scope	Biometric login, social sign-in — Phase 2+ consideration.

Dependencies	Backend: session token lifecycle audit; Firebase OTP service configuration review.
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FR-1.2 Product Image Upload Stability

Field	Detail
User Story	US-02
Priority	M — Must Have
Description	Resolve app crashes (ANR and force-close events) that occur during product image upload, particularly on mid-range Android devices.
Acceptance Criteria	1. Image upload completes successfully for files up to 10MB on Android 8.0 and above. 2. Crash rate for the upload flow drops to below 0.5% as reported in Play Console (from current elevated baseline). 3. If an upload fails due to network or server error, the user sees a clear error message and a 'Retry' button — the app does not close. 4. Partial uploads are not saved as broken listings.
Out of Scope	Video upload — not currently in scope.
Dependencies	Engineering: crash log analysis to identify top device/OS combinations; CDN configuration for upload endpoint.

FR-1.3 Notification Permission — Soft Ask

Field	Detail
User Story	US-03
Priority	M — Must Have
Description	Remove the mandatory notification permission gate that blocks users from proceeding with app setup. Replace with a contextual, soft-ask prompt.
Acceptance Criteria	1. New users can complete app setup and reach the home screen without granting notification permission. 2. A soft-ask notification prompt appears after the user completes their first meaningful action (e.g., views their first lead or completes profile setup). 3. Users who decline the permission can still access all core app features. 4. The prompt follows Android 13+ runtime permission guidelines.
Out of Scope	Push notification content strategy — handled separately by Marketing.
Dependencies	Design: prompt copy and placement; Engineering: permission flow refactor.

FR-1.4 WhatsApp Number Field Fix

Field	Detail
User Story	US-04
Priority	M — Must Have
Description	Fix the WhatsApp number field in profile settings so that updates persist correctly after the first save attempt.
Acceptance Criteria	1. A user who updates their WhatsApp number and taps 'Save' sees the new number reflected immediately without re-prompting. 2. The field accepts valid Indian mobile numbers (10-digit, with or without +91 prefix). 3. Saved changes persist across app restarts and re-logins. 4. If the save fails (e.g., network error), the user sees an error state — the field does not silently revert.
Out of Scope	WhatsApp Business API integration — future consideration.
Dependencies	Backend: profile update API validation and persistence audit.

Phase 2 — Improve (Target: Q1 2025)

FR-2.1 Navigation Simplification for Core Seller Flows

Field	Detail
User Stories	US-05, US-06, US-07, US-08
Priority	M — Must Have
Description	Audit and redesign the navigation paths for the five most-used seller flows to reduce task completion steps and surface key actions from the home screen.
In Scope	Update contact number, Delete/deactivate a listing, View and respond to a lead, Update catalogue images, View profile completion status.
Acceptance Criteria	1. Each of the five flows above is completable in 3 taps or fewer from the home screen (measured via usability test with 5 representative users). 2. A persistent bottom navigation bar surfaces Leads, Catalogue, and Profile at all times. 3. Product catalogue images render correctly on listing pages (no broken image placeholders in >99% of loads). 4. 'Delete listing' is accessible directly from the listing card — no more than 2 taps from listing view.
Dependencies	Design: UX audit and wireframes (4 weeks); Engineering: navigation refactor (6 weeks).

FR-2.2 Lead Preference Filters

Field	Detail
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User Stories	US-09, US-10, US-11
Priority	M — Must Have
Description	Introduce a rule-based lead preference configuration step during seller onboarding and within profile settings to allow sellers to filter leads by geography, category, and minimum order size.
Acceptance Criteria	1. During onboarding (after profile setup), sellers are presented with a 'Lead Preferences' step where they can specify: delivery state(s), product category preference(s), and minimum order size. 2. Sellers can update these preferences at any time from their profile settings. 3. Leads delivered to the seller's feed exclude leads that do not match all configured preferences. 4. A 'Not Relevant' button appears on each lead card — tapping it hides the lead and records the feedback signal for future tuning. 5. Sellers who configure preferences see a 'Filtered leads active' indicator on their leads page.
Note	This is a rule-based filter, not an ML recommendation system. The 'Not Relevant' signal is captured for future Phase 3 use only.
Dependencies	Backend: lead matching logic update; Product: preference schema design; Design: onboarding step and filter UI.

FR-2.3 Support SLA & Response Quality

Field	Detail
User Story	US-12
Priority	S — Should Have
Description	Implement a tiered support SLA framework: categorize inbound support contacts by issue type and route to the appropriate team with defined response and resolution windows.
Acceptance Criteria	1. All support contacts are acknowledged within 24 hours (automated or human) with a ticket reference number and expected resolution timeframe. 2. App crash/login issues are resolved or escalated within 2 business days. 3. Lead quality complaints receive a personalised (non-templated) response within 3 business days. 4. Play Store review responses for 1-star reviews reference the specific complaint raised — not a generic template. 5. Resolution rate (user confirms issue resolved) is tracked as a dashboard metric from launch.
Dependencies	Customer Support team: SLA policy definition, response templates overhaul, tooling (CRM workflow update).

Phase 3 — Build Trust (Target: Q2 2025)

FR-3.1 Seller Onboarding — Expectation Module

Field	Detail
User Story	US-13

Priority	S — Should Have
Description	Add a 'What to expect in your first 30 days' module to the post-subscription onboarding flow, setting accurate expectations for lead volume ramp-up time and best practices for getting early traction.
Acceptance Criteria	1. After subscription activation, sellers are shown a 3–5 screen onboarding module before reaching the home screen. 2. Module covers: typical lead volume in days 1–7, 8–14, and 15–30; tips for catalogue completion to improve lead quality; how to contact support. 3. Module is skippable after the second screen. 4. Completion rate of the module (reaching screen 3+) is tracked. 5. Module content is editable by the Marketing/Content team via CMS without an app release.
Dependencies	Design: content and UX; Content/Marketing: copy; Engineering: CMS integration for module content.

FR-3.2 Seller Activity Dashboard

Field	Detail
Priority	C — Could Have
Description	Build a lightweight seller-facing dashboard showing lead activity, catalogue health, and response rate metrics so that sellers can self-diagnose performance issues.
Acceptance Criteria	1. Dashboard surfaces: total leads received (last 30 days), leads responded to, catalogue completeness score (%), and profile views. 2. Data refreshes daily (not real-time). 3. A 'Improve my catalogue' CTA links to the top incomplete fields on their profile. 4. Dashboard is accessible from the home screen within 1 tap.
Dependencies	Data engineering: lead and catalogue metrics pipeline; Design: dashboard layout.

7. Non-Functional Requirements

Category	Req ID	Requirement
Performance	NFR-01	App cold start time must not exceed 3 seconds on mid-range Android devices (≤4GB RAM, Android 8.0+).
Performance	NFR-02	OTP API response time must be ≤ 2 seconds at P95 under normal load.
Performance	NFR-03	Image upload API must handle files up to 10MB within 30 seconds on a standard 4G connection.
Reliability	NFR-04	App crash rate (ANR + force close) must remain below 1% as reported in Google Play Console after Phase 1 release.

Reliability	NFR-05	Core flows (login, lead view, catalogue update) must function correctly on Android 8.0 and above.
Usability	NFR-06	All new UI elements must meet WCAG 2.1 Level AA contrast ratio requirements.
Usability	NFR-07	All new flows must be usable on screen sizes from 5.0" to 6.7" without horizontal scrolling.
Security	NFR-08	OTP tokens must expire after 10 minutes and be invalidated after first use.
Security	NFR-09	User profile data (mobile number, WhatsApp number) must be transmitted over HTTPS and not logged in plaintext.
Localisation	NFR-10	All new user-facing strings must support Hindi (hi-IN) in addition to English, using the existing localisation framework.

8. Success Metrics & Measurement Plan

Metrics are structured as North Star, Phase-level, and Guardrail. Baselines should be established in the two weeks before Phase 1 release.

Type	Metric	Baseline	Target (6 months)
North Star	Google Play average star rating	2.28 (2025 YTD)	≥ 2.8 by end of Phase 2
Phase 1	App crash rate (Play Console)	Establish at launch	Reduce 30–40% vs. baseline within 8 weeks
Phase 1	OTP login success rate	Establish at launch	≥ 99% success on valid OTP entry
Phase 1	Notification permission acceptance rate	Establish at launch	Increase 15–25% (soft ask vs. hard gate)
Phase 2	Core flow task completion (5 flows, ≤3 taps)	Audit pre-redesign	All 5 flows meet ≤3-tap target
Phase 2	Lead relevance feedback — 'Not Relevant' rate	0 (new feature)	Establish baseline; trend downward over 90 days
Phase 2	Support resolution rate	0% tracked (no metric)	60%+ resolutions acknowledged within SLA
Phase 3	30-day paid subscriber retention rate	Establish via CRM	Improve 5–8% vs. pre-initiative baseline
Phase 3	Onboarding module completion rate (screen 3+)	0 (new feature)	≥ 55% of new subscribers reach screen 3

Guardrail	Support ticket volume	Track from Phase 1	Must not increase >10% post any release
Guardrail	Session length (avg. per DAU)	Track from Phase 1	Must not decrease — indicates engagement maintained

9. Release Plan

Phase	Target	Features	Success Gate to Next Phase
Phase 1 Stabilize	Q4 2024 (8 weeks)	FR-1.1 – FR-1.4	Crash rate reduced ≥25%; OTP success ≥99%; no new P1 bugs in UAT
Phase 2 Improve	Q1 2025 (10 weeks)	FR-2.1 – FR-2.3	All 5 core flows ≤3 taps; lead preference adoption ≥30% of new sellers; Play Store rating trending ≥2.6
Phase 3 Build Trust	Q2 2025 (10 weeks)	FR-3.1 – FR-3.2	Onboarding module completion ≥50%; subscriber 30-day retention improved vs. baseline

10. Risks & Mitigations

	Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
	OTP fix introduces regression in other auth flows	Medium	High	Full auth regression test suite before Phase 1 release; staged rollout to 10% of users first
	Lead preference filters reduce lead volume, causing subscriber complaints	Medium	High	Set clear expectation in UI: 'Filtering leads improves relevance but may reduce volume.' Monitor lead volume per seller in first 30 days.
	Navigation redesign (Phase 2) creates confusion for existing power users	Low	Medium	Run usability tests with 5 existing heavy users pre-launch; provide a 'What's changed' tooltip on first app open post-update
	Review data does not represent iOS or web users — fixes may not address full user base	Medium	Medium	Replicate analysis on App Store reviews post-Phase 1; plan iOS parity audit for H2 2025
	Support SLA (FR-2.3) requires Customer Support team capacity that may not be available	Medium	Medium	Begin Support team scoping and CRM workflow changes in parallel with Phase 1 engineering; SLA launch can trail Phase 2 app release by 4 weeks if needed
	Phase 1 improvements do not move Play Store rating within	Low	Medium	Rating is a lagging metric. Focus leading indicators (crash rate, login success) as

	expected timeframe		interim health signals; communicate this framing to stakeholders upfront
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11. Dependencies

Team	Dependency	Detail
Engineering	Auth service	OTP session token audit and fix (FR-1.1) requires backend access and a dedicated sprint slot.
Engineering	Upload CDN	Image upload crash fix (FR-1.2) may require CDN endpoint or file handling configuration change — assess in spike.
Design	UX audit	FR-2.1 navigation redesign requires a UX audit and wireframes before engineering can begin. Estimated 4 weeks.
Customer Support	SLA framework	FR-2.3 requires Customer Support to define issue categories, SLA windows, and retrain agents. Must start in parallel with Phase 1.
Data / Analytics	Metric baselines	Crash rate, login success rate, and session metrics must be instrumented and baselined before Phase 1 release to enable post-launch measurement.
Sales / GTM	Onboarding module content	FR-3.1 expectation module requires Sales alignment on what is and isn't promised during subscription — content must be reviewed and approved by Sales and Legal.
Backend	Lead matching	FR-2.2 lead preference filters require a backend rule engine update to the lead delivery service.

12. Open Questions

The following questions must be resolved before final sign-off on Phase 1 and Phase 2 requirements.

ID	Question	Owner	Due
OQ-01	What is the current OTP error rate (from backend logs)? This data is needed to baseline FR-1.1 and set a credible success target.	Engineering Lead	Week 1
OQ-02	What is the top 5 device/OS split of users experiencing image upload crashes? Required to scope FR-1.2 device coverage.	Engineering Lead	Week 1
OQ-03	Do we have access to Play Console ANR and crash data at the flow level? If not, what instrumentation needs to be added before Phase 1 release?	Engineering Lead	Week 1
OQ-	What does the Sales team currently promise regarding lead	Sales Lead + Legal	Week 2

04	volume in subscription agreements? This informs how honest the FR-3.1 expectation module can be.		
OQ-05	Is there an existing lead delivery algorithm, or is delivery currently undifferentiated? This determines the complexity of FR-2.2.	Backend Lead	Week 2
OQ-06	What CRM system does Customer Support use? Determines effort required to implement SLA tracking for FR-2.3.	Support Lead	Week 3
OQ-07	Are there App Store (iOS) reviews showing the same patterns? Should iOS be brought into Phase 2 scope?	PM	Week 4

13. Approvals & Sign-off

This document requires sign-off from the following stakeholders before Phase 1 development begins.

Name & Role	Signature	Date	Status
VP Product			Pending
Engineering Lead			Pending
UX Lead			Pending
Customer Support Lead			Pending
Sales Lead			Pending

This PRD is based on discovery work conducted from 580 publicly available Google Play Store reviews. All requirements, timelines, and metrics are directional. Final scope, effort estimates, and success criteria must be validated with engineering, design, and business stakeholders before development begins.